

Kingdom of Apples. Thomas knew it was necessary to secure support from an influential noble respected by the Seelie and Unseelie Courts and, as one of the most skilled politicians in the land, Mab's acknowledgement would be invaluable to ensure David's right to rule. However, Thomas found out that the Queen already knew about David and Caliburn, but refused to acknowledge that the future of their rule belonged in the hands of someone so young. She ordered her guards to dismiss them from her presence.

As guards closed in on David, a shining griffon materialized before their eyes, shielding the young boy's body with its wings. Thomas cried out with the words of the dreamed prophecy to Mab and her courtiers: "The son of the griffin and the sword that was lost shall come together in the apple bower!" Knowing his words to be true, Queen Mab acknowledged David by proclaiming him the new High King of the fae.

David displayed an innate acumen for politics, and this pleased Queen Mab, who took it upon herself to further his skills. He also proved compassionate and empathetic towards commoners, for he had listened carefully to Thomas' stories of the Interregnum.

David truly desired to unify all Kithain in peace and, in his efforts, he sent emissaries asking commoner leaders to join him in negotiations. The commoners' memories of the Beltaine Massacre proved too hard to overcome, however. Three years of unanswered invitations went by until a group of trolls met with David and confirmed his intentions, thus making discussions a real possibility. Their acceptance of the young king spread like wildfire throughout the nation, leading more prominent commoner leaders to follow suit and accept the invitation.

David's first war was one of diplomacy. With the aid of Mab and Morwen, the king met with the leaders of both sides before eventually bringing them together for joint discussions. His trials at the negotiating table are those of political legends, much to Mab's pride. While commoners demanded the return of conquered territory and for David to make formal restitutions, as well as apologize for the events of the war, the Arcadian sidhe relentlessly dismissed all requests, referring to the Dreaming's acknowledgement of the right to rule. In time, David slowly convinced both sides to concede as he explained his vision for a new kingdom. Though many of the Arcadian sidhe saw his treaty as a betrayal of their kith, the years of warfare and bloodshed swayed enough influential nobles to David's cause.

The Treaty of Concord's terms confirmed the sidhe right to rule, and decreed that changelings would live by the medieval paradigm that they preferred. It also recognized the huge efforts that commoners performed in service of the Dreaming throughout the Interregnum, and made it possible to grant them ennoblement in service of the kingdom. Furthermore, by creating an advising body, known as the Parliament of Dreams, the treaty granted commoners unprecedented influence under sidhe rulership. Finally, the agreement ratified the Seven Kingdoms and united them under the name Concordia, which David felt honored the treaty itself and the spirit of unity that it represented.

The Calm Before the Storm

Following David's ascension to High King, his name became synonymous with ferocity in battle, and legendary compassion and wisdom. During his final years as a resident of Queen Mab's palace, David ordered the construction of a grand castle to act as the seat for his power and a symbol of Concordia. He named the stronghold Tara-Nar and moved there with his sister, who continued to act as his advisor.

Life under High King David was not easy, with Banality constantly threatening chimerical life, but under his rulership, Kithain society flourished. Freeholds lost in the war were rebuilt, motleys ventured out into the Dreaming in hopes of finding a way to Arcadia, and the commoner and noble relationships improved by working together in the Parliament of Dreams.

The Evanesence

The 1990s initially made access to Glamour easier for changelings of all social standing. Technological advancements entered into a cycle, propelling contenders to build on discoveries more quickly, granting the public access to new objects that made life easier for both mortals and fae. Mobile phones, computer advancements, and internet access became household staples, while international travelling increased, especially in Europe following the Schengen Convention. EU citizens received free movement and the membership states that signed the agreement abolished systematic internal border controls while adapting a common visa policy. Where the freedom of mind worked to the Dreaming's advantage during the 1960s, the early 1990s aided in fueling Glamour by increasing a sense of unification among mortals.

Yet, it didn't take long before the darkness of the decade reared its ugly side and fueled the Dreaming with Glamour from more sinister and malevolent forces. The Gulf War, the Yugoslavian Civil War, the Kosovo war, and the Rwandan genocide are but a few of the many events that nurtured nightmares and horrors. In the same way that the space race affected humanity's mind, the perceived closeness and repeated conflicts within short periods of time fueled the darkness from the Dreaming.

It looked like the end of the millennium would be a happy one for Concordia's subjects when High King David met the beautiful Faerilyth of House Eiluned. Theirs was a passionate, whirlwind romance, but one that ended in tragedy. Upon embarking on their grand tour of Concordia, David disappeared without a trace while staying with King Melige, Faerilyth's uncle and guardian, in the Kingdom of Willows. Immediate accusations of assassination and kidnapping spread across the realm. Some blamed the new High Queen, others secret organizations, and a few even Regent Morwen. However, amidst chaos, hope appeared in the form of an eshu storyteller called Seif.

The same night that the High King vanished, Caliburn materialized in Seif's possession, communicating its wish to be reunited with its master. Bound by love and loyalty for his egalitarian king, Seif met with the High Queen and her advisors, who acknowledged the task the Dreaming set upon the eshu. Faerilyth ennobled Seif and charged him with locating David